

The Confluence Trading System

The 50→200 rotation, the 9/50 EMA trigger, and the 30-point Balance grid — the complete NQ intraday method, with full indicator build instructions.

Method, terminology and all quoted material are Trieu Trades'. This document is an independent synthesis of two recorded bootcamp sessions, reorganised into build order for personal study.

INSTRUMENT

NQ · Nasdaq

TIMEFRAME

1-min & 3-min

PLATFORM

TradingView

SOURCES

2 bootcamp sessions

The System, End to End

This edition merges both bootcamp sessions into one build-order manual. Everything is sequenced the way you would actually use it: context first, then the chart build, then how to read it, then the four setups, then execution and risk.

PART	SECTION	WHAT IT COVERS
I	Market Context	Sector rotation, contract maths, news discipline
II	Building the Chart	Exact MA/EMA settings, the Balance grid, add-on indicators
III	Reading the Chart	Trend states, volume, gaps, cost basis
IV	The Four Setups	50→200, the 9/50 trigger, A-shape rejection, balance-to-balance
V	Execution & Risk	Stops, 2:1, trimming vs trailing, order hygiene
VI	When Not to Trade	The conditions that produce losses
VII	Daily Routine	The timeline, the pre-market checklist
VIII	Practice & Progression	Replay drilling, account mechanics
IX	Quick Reference	One-page trade card

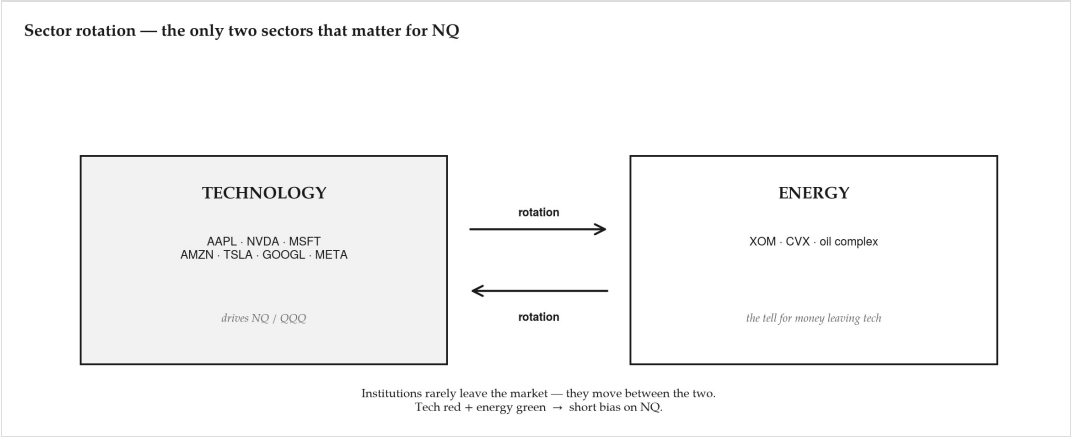
What changed in this edition

The first guide treated the 9/50 EMA cross as the whole setup. It is not — it is the *trigger*. The trade is the **50 MA → 200 MA rotation**, and it only qualifies when those two are at least 30 points apart. This edition also adds the **Balance grid** (a 30-point rotation lattice), the **100 MA** as the trim level, the **A-shape rejection**, and step-by-step indicator settings.

“All I’m looking for is the 9 EMA cross and 50 to 200. That’s it. If I see a balance-to-balance trade, I’ll take that.”

Market Context

Before any chart is opened, one question gets answered: is money flowing into technology or out of it? On NQ that single read sets your directional bias for the session.



The market is split into 11 sectors, but for NQ only two of them carry information.

The heat map is checked daily on finviz.com → **Maps**. Cycle the performance window through **1 day → 1 week → 1 month** and watch which half of the map is green. Tech red while energy is green means capital is rotating out of the Nasdaq — trade the short side. The reverse means longs.

Same asset, different wrapper

NQ, QQQ and NDX are the same underlying exposure at different price scales. So are ES, SPY and SPX. QQQ and SPY move together roughly 90% of the time — closely correlated, not identical.

Why NQ and not options

Futures have no time decay. A 5-point move is a 5-point move whether it takes ten seconds or three hours — there is no theta, delta or gamma eroding the position while you wait for the thesis to play out.

CONTRACT MATHS — COMMIT THESE

MEASURE	NQ (MINI)	MNQ (MICRO)
1 tick	\$5.00	\$0.50
1 point (4 ticks)	\$20.00	\$2.00
1 balance (30 points)	\$600	\$60
A 70-point move	\$1,400	\$140

NQ can travel 30–100 ticks inside a single second. That cuts identically in both directions, which is why the stop is not optional.

News & Event Discipline

Technical analysis governs the chart until a headline overrides it. The economic calendar is checked **the night before**, never at the open.

THE HARD RULE	If high-impact data prints at 7:30, you are not in a position at 7:29. Flat through the release, then trade the reaction.
DON'T PREDICT THE REACTION	The market only sees good or bad, and often disagrees with what seems obvious. Read the headline, then let price decide direction and follow it — do not position ahead of your own interpretation.
NEWS SOURCES	X/Twitter is the fastest feed. Two accounts carry most of it: DeltaOne and Financial Juice — both push transcripts and releases almost immediately.
HEDGING	Taking opposite positions across multiple prop accounts to straddle a release is hedging. It is bannable at prop firms and penalised at retail brokers. Don't.

The manipulation caveat

Large, well-connected participants routinely position ahead of announcements. You cannot front-run that and should not try. The realistic goal is to read the move after it starts and take a portion of it — not to predict the catalyst.

Which sessions actually matter

NQ trades nearly around the clock, but liquidity is concentrated in the New York session. Overnight and after-hours volume is thin, which makes breakouts unreliable and stops easier to run. Unless there is a specific reason, trade the regular session.

Building the Chart

Six moving averages, two ribbons. TradingView's entry tier caps you at five indicators, so both sets are loaded through the **MA Ribbon** indicator rather than six separate ones.

RIBBON 1 — SIMPLE MOVING AVERAGES (THE MAP)

LENGTH	TYPE	COLOUR	LINE WEIGHT & ROLE
50	SMA	 Yellow light: amber	Thickest — the launch line
100	SMA	 Pink light: magenta	Thickest — the trim level
200	SMA	 Green light: teal	Thickest — the destination

RIBBON 2 — EXPONENTIAL MOVING AVERAGES (THE TRIGGER)

LENGTH	TYPE	COLOUR	LINE WEIGHT & ROLE
9	EMA	 Light blue light: strong blue	Thinnest — trigger & trailing line
21	EMA	 White light: slate grey	Thinnest — the shoulder tap
50	EMA	 Dark red light: purple	Thinnest — the line the 9 must cross

Why both families, and why they are not interchangeable

Simple MAs weight every bar in the window equally, so they lag and stay smooth — that is exactly what you want from a target line that shouldn't jitter. Exponential MAs weight recent price more heavily and track the candles almost in real time — which is what you want from a trigger and a trailing stop. Using an EMA as your target, or an SMA as your trail, breaks both jobs.

If your chart background is light

The colours above are the session's own, chosen for a dark chart. On a light background white and pale yellow disappear entirely — use the *light* alternates listed in the colour column instead. Red and green are also worth avoiding for MA lines if you run a supply/demand indicator, so the ladder never reads as a zone.

Set both ribbons to **Close** as the source. Keep the SMA ribbon on the thickest available line weight and the EMA ribbon on the thinnest — at a glance you should be able to tell the map from the trigger without reading the legend.

Drawing the Balance Grid

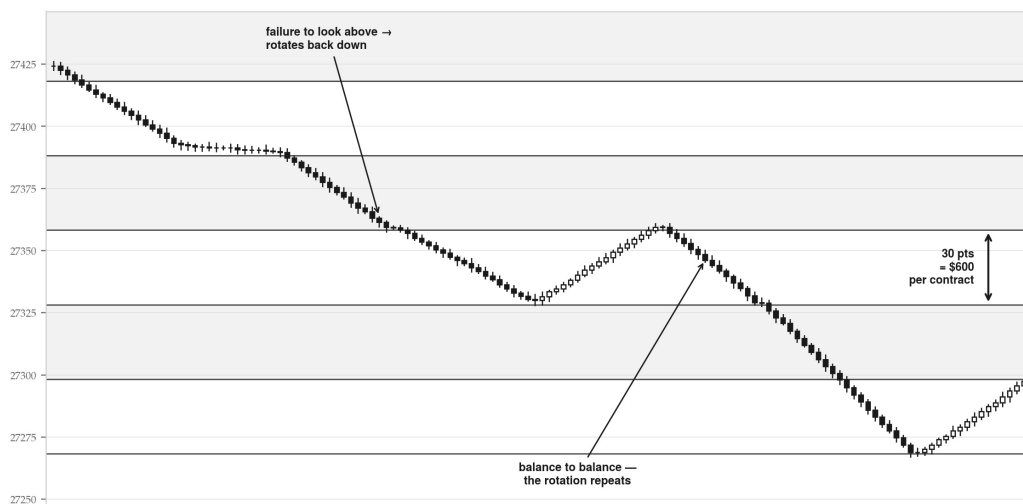
NQ rotates in **30-point increments**. The grid is a fixed lattice of horizontal lines 30 points apart, built once with the Fib Retracement tool and reused forever.

1. Select the **Fib Retracement** tool and draw any arbitrary drag on the chart — the drag itself doesn't matter, you are about to overwrite the coordinates.
2. Double-click the drawing to open settings. Tick **every** level and enable “**use one color**” — set it to white so the whole lattice reads as one grid.
3. Relabel the levels as a continuous integer run: **-13, -12, -11 ... -1, 0, 1, 2 ... +10**. Do not skip zero.
4. Enable **extend lines left** and **extend lines right**, plus price levels and text.
5. In the coordinates panel, set the two anchor prices exactly **30 points apart** — for example 27418.25 and 27448.25. The time/bar coordinates are irrelevant; ignore them.
6. Save it: **Template → Save as → “balance”**. Skipping this step means rebuilding the whole lattice by hand later.

Re-centring — a ten-second daily job

If price has drifted to the top or bottom of the visible lattice, reopen the settings and replace the anchor pair with any current level ending in the same decimals, plus 30. Once you have memorised one anchor number, every other level is that number ± 30 . If price is already sitting mid-lattice, leave it alone.

The balance grid — NQ rotates in 30-point increments



The lattice, once anchored, keeps working across thousands of points of market travel.

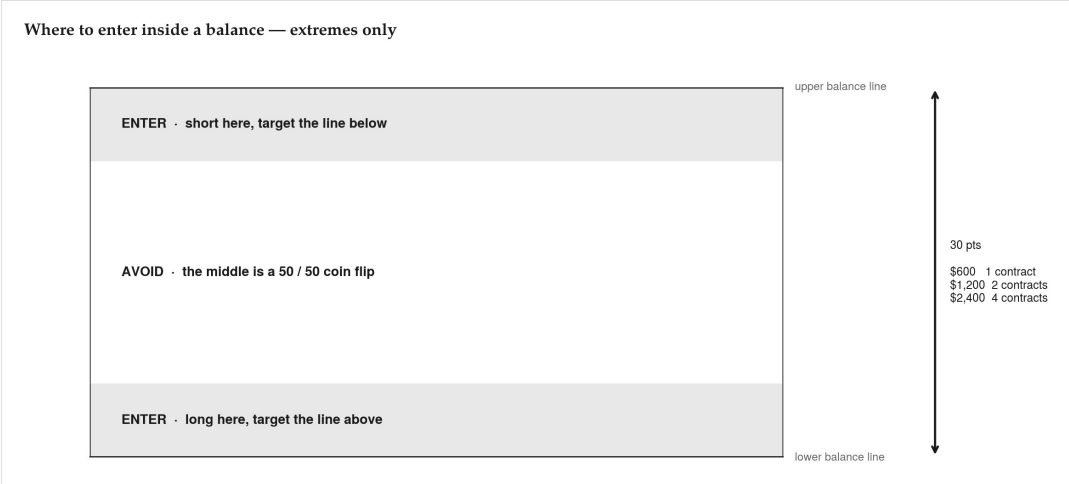
Why the Market Moves in 30s

The rationale taught in the session is a story about institutional behaviour: a large desk enters a position, rival desks see the flow and pile in, and each successive entry multiplies the earlier participants' exposure. The move runs until someone blinks and closes — at which point the rotation reverses.

The chain, as taught

Desk A commits capital → Desk B follows, doubling A's position value → Desk C follows, tripling A's and doubling B's. It becomes a game of chicken over who exits first. Retail sits downstream of all of it — the objective is to take a slice of the move, not to outlast the participants driving it.

Treat the mechanism as a model, not a fact
The 30-point figure was passed down from floor-trader mentors and is presented without a published source. Whether the causal story is literally true matters less than whether the levels hold — and that is something you can verify yourself on replay before risking money on it. Test it, don't take it.



Balance extremes are the only entries worth taking — the midpoint offers no edge.

FAILURE TO LOOK ABOVE	Price pokes above a balance line and cannot continue → expect rotation back down to the line below.
FAILURE TO LOOK BELOW	Price pokes below and cannot continue → expect rotation back up to the line above.
USE AS TARGETS	Balance lines double as scale-out levels: trim a contract at each line and trail the remainder to the next.

The Add-On Indicators

These are proprietary TradingView scripts granted on an invite-only basis. **None of them generates the trade** — they reduce workload and add conviction to a setup you already identified.

Auto Trend

Repopulates every 30 minutes and draws the prevailing trend channel automatically. Rejection off the channel top is a short toward the channel bottom, and vice versa. Its real value is removing one thing you would otherwise have to hunt for manually.

Supply & Demand

Plots a demand zone (blue, below) and a supply zone (purple, above), with a yellow box marking a potential forming zone. Usable as support and resistance — but its most important signal is negative: **when the two zones touch or overlap, do not trade**. Supply and demand have collapsed into each other, no one is transacting with conviction, and the market will chop.

Volume Tracker

Recolours candles that clear a volume threshold — **blue** for a high-volume buy candle, **yellow** for a high-volume sell candle. Fires only during regular trading hours; if it triggers after hours, something material has happened. Best read on a 3- to 5-minute chart.

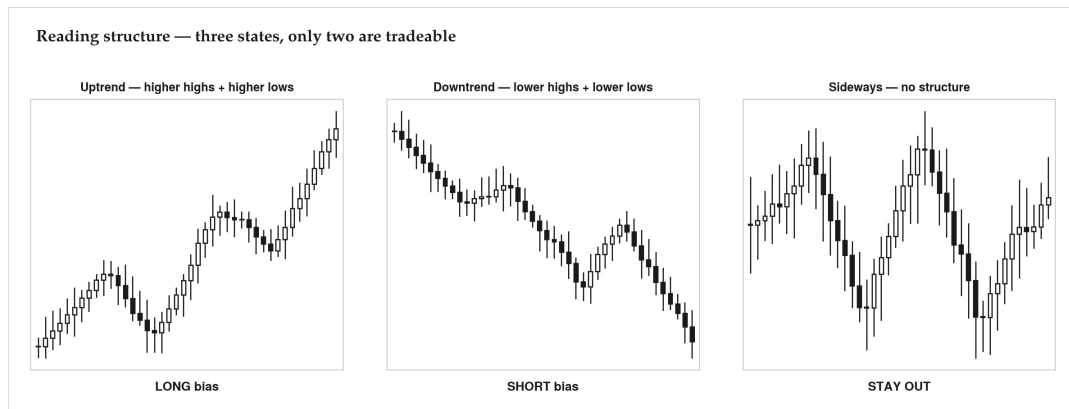
Strategy Builder & Gaps

The strategy builder encodes the EMA/MA logic into long and short triggers, and the gaps script marks unfilled imbalances. The trigger typically fires **after** a correctly-taken entry — that is by design. It is a confirmation to *add* or *hold*, never the reason to enter.

“My setup is what’s telling you to get in, not the indicator. The indicator is just another thing to tell you.”

Reading the Chart

Three structural states exist. Two of them pay, and recognising the third is what protects the account.



Uptrend, downtrend, and the chop that separates disciplined traders from busy ones.

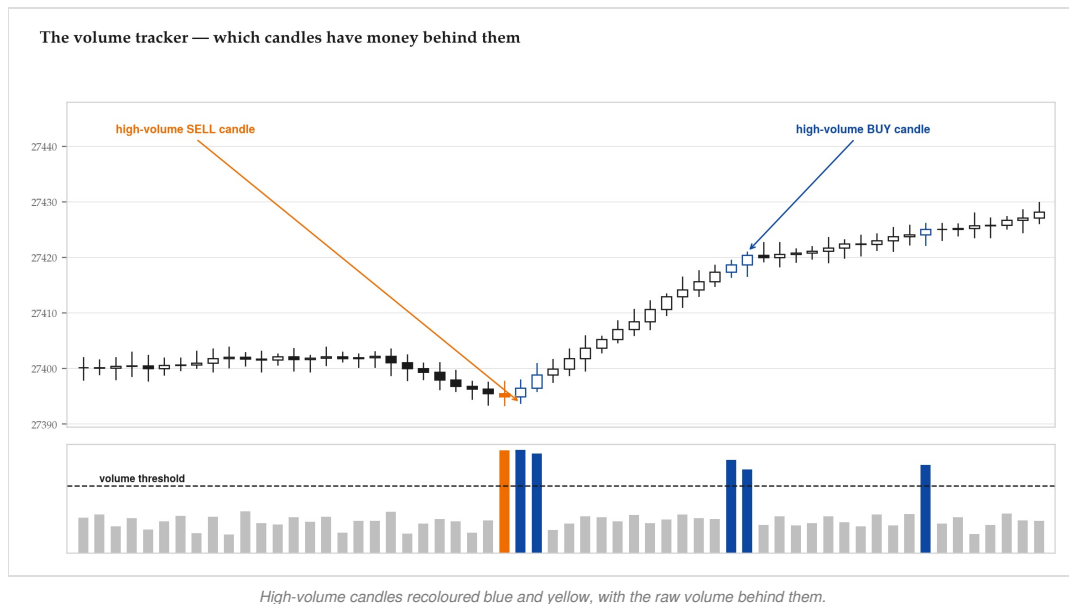
UPTREND	A sequence of higher lows in conjunction with higher highs. Connect the lows, extend the line, and treat a clean break as a move away from the range.
DOWNTREND	A sequence of lower highs in conjunction with lower lows. Same construction, inverted.
SIDEWAYS	No structure — a loaded spring that can release either way. Stay flat until momentum appears <i>outside</i> the range.
ALWAYS LOOK LEFT	Before trusting any level, check whether price has reacted there before. A line with history behind it is worth more than a line drawn today.

The consolidation trap

Trying to trade a ninety-minute sideways range produces the worst sequence in trading: you short the apparent breakdown, it reverses; you flip long into the apparent breakout, it reverses again. Each round trip costs money and confidence. The correct action is no action.

Volume — The Breakout Filter

Volume is what separates a real breakout from a wick through a line. The pattern to look for is a run of visibly low-volume candles inside consolidation, followed by a single candle whose volume expands sharply as price clears the boundary.



What a blue candle means

Heavy buying pressure went through. If you are long, this is a reason to hold rather than trim. It is **not** a guarantee of continuation.

What a yellow candle means

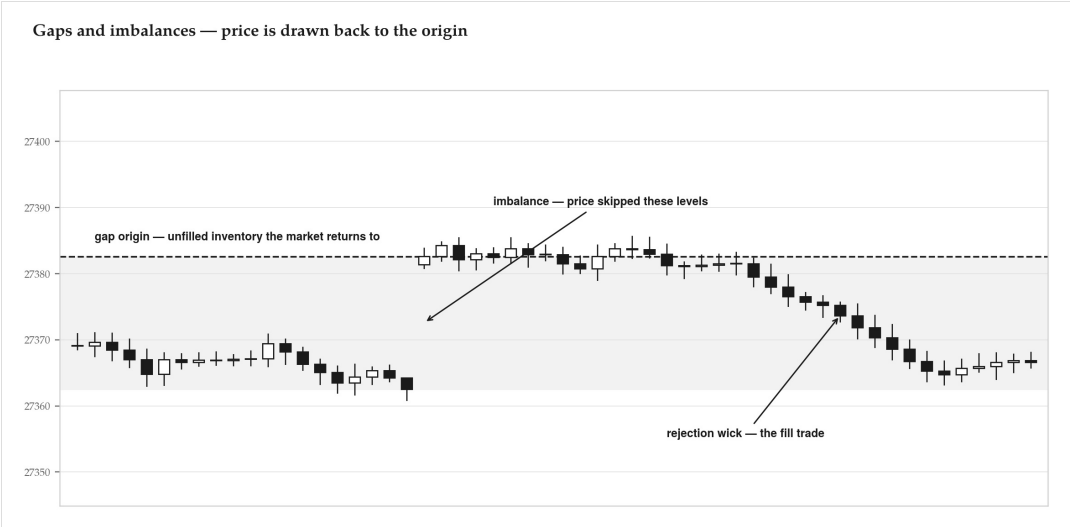
Heavy selling pressure went through. If you are short, hold. If you are long, this is a reason to look for the exit before the move flips.

The honest reading

A high-volume candle tells you conviction was present in that bar — nothing more. Heavy buying also shows up at the *top* of a move as the last buyers get filled, and heavy selling at the *bottom* as the last sellers capitulate. So a blue candle is not automatically bullish, nor a yellow one bearish: read it as confirmation of the move you are already in, not as a standalone entry signal.

Gaps, Imbalances & Cost Basis

A gap forms when an aggressive order moves price faster than two-sided trading can occur, leaving unsold inventory behind. The market tends to return and transact at those skipped prices.



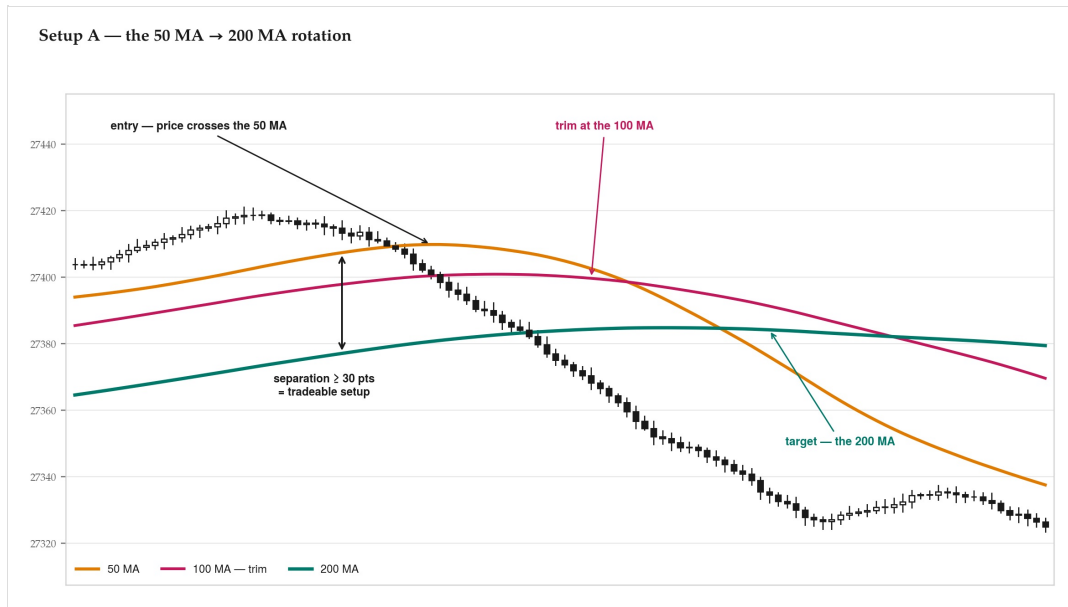
AS A TARGET	An unfilled gap above or below current price is a legitimate draw — useful for deciding how far to let a runner travel.
CONFIRMATION	A rejection wick at the gap edge on the 1-minute chart is the trigger to take the fill trade.
COST BASIS	A price band traded repeatedly across multiple sessions. Once marked it is kept permanently — price returns to these levels far more often than chance would suggest.
SINGLE PRINTS	On a TPO/market-profile chart, thin one-wide areas are the profile equivalent of a gap and behave the same way.

On the “99% fill rate”

Gaps fill often enough to be tradeable, but the frequently-quoted figure is a teaching heuristic rather than a measured statistic. Gaps far outside the current range may take months to fill or never fill at all. Trade the ones near current price; treat distant ones as context.

Setup A • The 50 → 200 Rotation

This is the trade. Everything else in the system either triggers it, confirms it, or manages it.



Separation qualifies the setup; the 100 MA trims; the 200 MA pays.

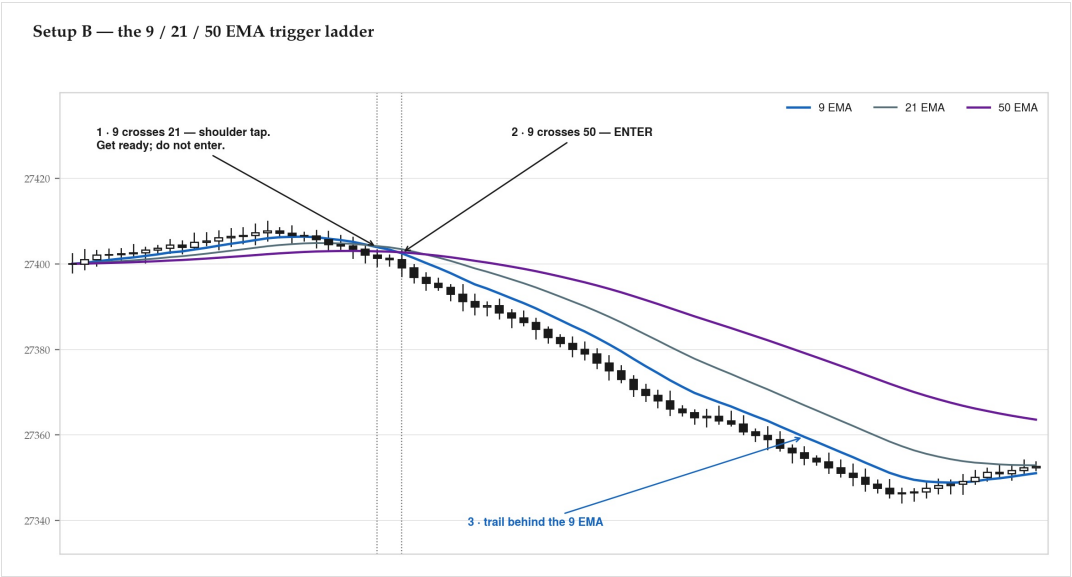
1. **Measure the gap between the 50 MA and 200 MA.** Under 30 points, there is no trade — the move isn't worth the risk. 30 points is the floor; 50–70 point separations are the good ones.
2. **Wait for price to reach and cross the 50 MA.** This is the launch line. A test that fails and comes back is normal — you want the actual break.
3. **Enter in the direction of the break.** Price leaving the 50 MA makes the 200 MA the destination. The mirror version also counts: when price is already at the 200 and turns back, the 50 becomes the target instead.
4. **Trim one contract at the 100 MA.** It sits between the two and is the natural partial-profit level.
5. **Target just short of the 200 MA.** These are lagging lines — the 200 will curl toward price as you approach, so don't wait for an exact touch.

Why this repeats daily

The relationship is symmetrical and self-renewing: after price completes a 50→200 rotation, the averages re-stack in the opposite configuration and the next rotation sets up in reverse. You are not hunting a rare pattern — you are waiting for a recurring one.

Setup B - The 9 / 21 / 50 EMA Trigger

Setup A tells you a trade exists and where it's going. Setup B tells you *when* to press the button. In practice they are one trade.



The shoulder tap, the trigger, and the trail — the full sequence of a single entry.

EVENT	ACTION	WHY
9 EMA nears the 21	WATCH	Lines running parallel and converging — a move is building.
9 crosses the 21	PREPARE	The shoulder tap. Get the order ready. Still not an entry.
9 crosses the 50 EMA	ENTER	The primary signal — taken every time it appears with separation present.
Strategy trigger fires	ADD	Confirmation arriving after entry. Reason to size up or hold, not to enter.
Candle closes past the 9	EXIT	The trail is broken. Out.

Entering early

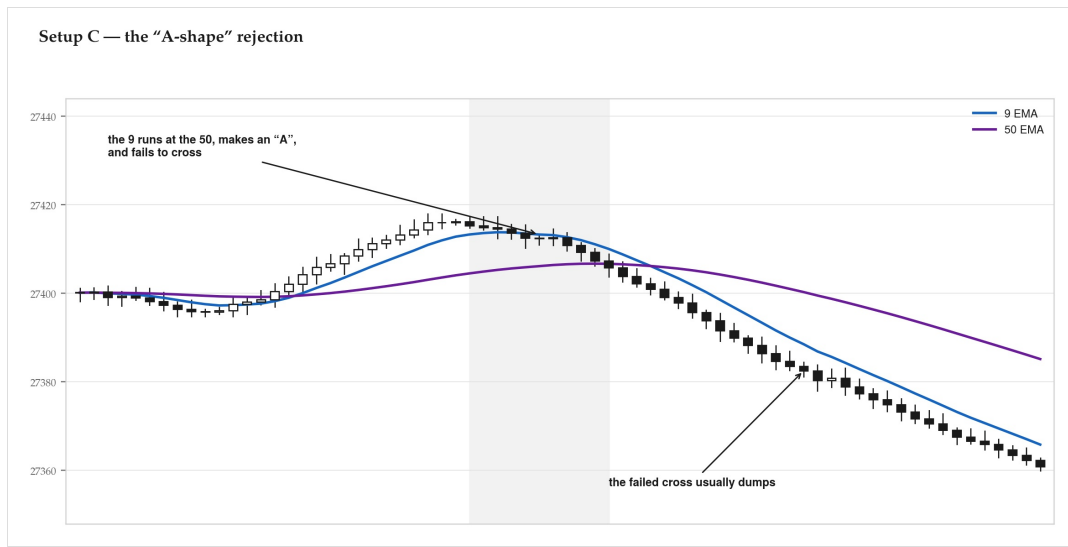
A **buy-stop** (or sell-stop) placed just past the 50 EMA gets you filled automatically on the cross without having to watch for it. You can also enter at a balance extreme before the cross — earlier price, less confirmation.

Where the cross happens matters

The highest-quality version occurs **at the 50 MA itself** — the EMA trigger and the SMA launch line coinciding. When both fire at the same price, that is the trade.

Setup C · The A-Shape Rejection

The cross that doesn't happen is also a signal. When the 9 EMA runs at the 50, rounds over into an “A” shape and turns away without crossing, the failure itself tends to produce a move — often as clean as a genuine crossover.



Rejection away from the 50 EMA — harder to spot, and frequently the sharper move.

Harder to trade than it looks

This setup asks you to act on the *absence* of a signal, which means you are judging a rounding shape in real time rather than waiting for a clean line cross. Treat it as an intermediate pattern — learn it on replay before trading it live.

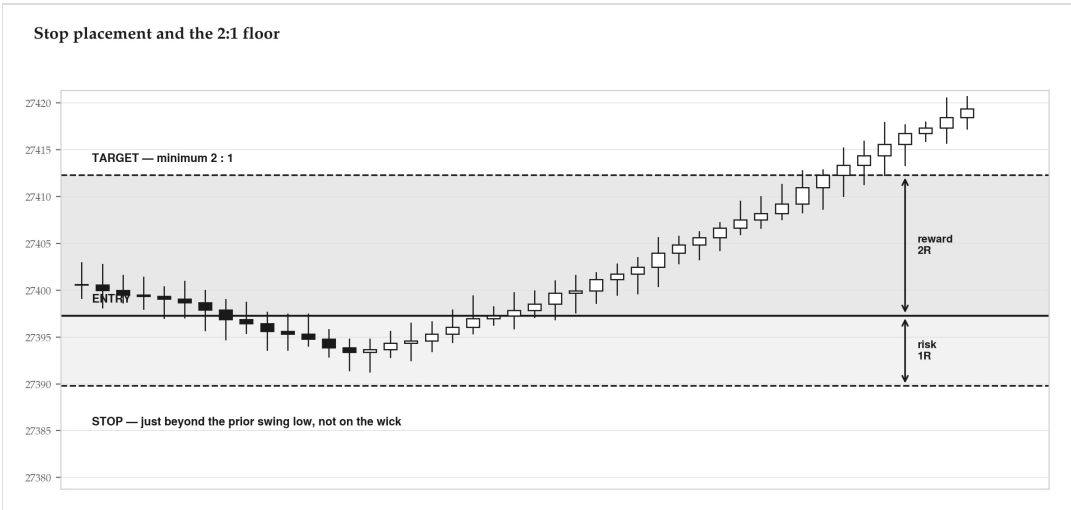
Setup D · Balance to Balance

The simplest trade in the system and the one requiring the most patience. Enter at a balance extreme, target the next line, 30 points away.

- ☐ Price arrives at the **top or bottom** of a balance — never the middle.
- ☐ It fails to continue through (failure to look above or below).
- ☐ The EMAs agree with the direction of the expected rotation.
- ☐ Target: the next balance line. **30 points = \$600 per contract.**
- ☐ Trail behind the balance you just cleared, not behind price.

“If you can nail one balance trade, you are good for the day.”

Execution & Risk



Structure sets the stop; the stop sets the minimum acceptable target.

STOP PLACEMENT

Just beyond the prior swing high or low — a little past the wick, never exactly on it. Look left and pick a level that already has structural meaning.

DOLLAR CEILING

A working reference is roughly **\$300 of risk on one contract**. This is a personal ceiling, not a universal rule — yours should be a fixed fraction of your account, decided before the session.

SIZE VS STOP

The two are inversely linked. If one contract risks \$300 at a given stop, two contracts risk \$600 at the same stop — so as size goes up the stop must come **closer**, not stay put.

MINIMUM R : R

2 : 1. Risking \$300 to make \$115 is a losing structure however good the win rate feels.

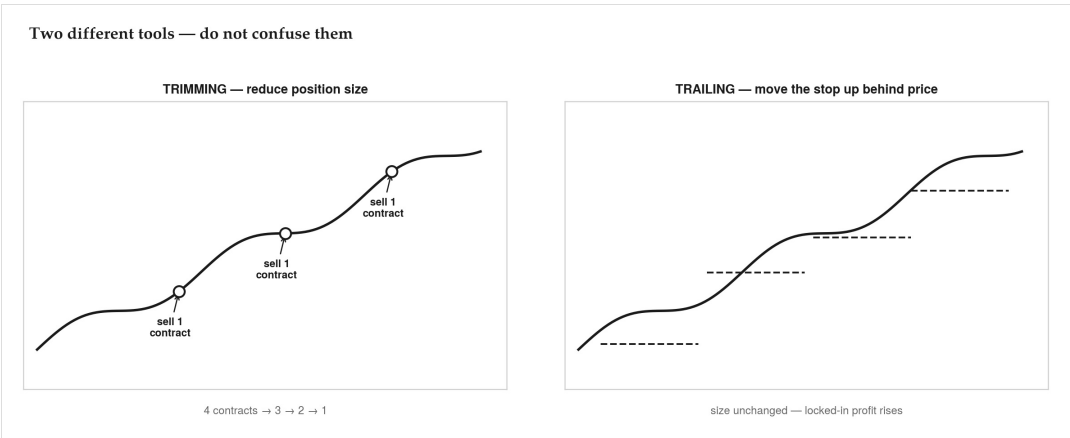
BREAK-EVEN

Once meaningfully in profit, the stop can be pulled to entry — or into profit — so the trade can no longer lose.

On averaging down

The sessions show adding to a losing position at a support level. Understand what this is: it increases risk on a trade the market has already disagreed with, and it is how accounts die. If you use it at all, the original stop must hold for the *combined* position — and it must be a planned entry at a level you identified in advance, never a reaction to being underwater.

Trimming, Trailing & Order Hygiene



Trimming changes size. Trailing changes the stop. They are used together, not interchangeably.

THE TRAILING LADDER

TRAIL BEHIND	CHARACTER	WHEN TO USE IT
■ 9 EMA	Tight	Default. Exit the moment a candle closes through it.
□ 21 EMA	Looser	When you want to survive noise — but only if the 21 is close to the 9 . If it has drifted far away you are handing back too much.
□ Balance line	Structural	On balance-to-balance trades — trail above/below the line you just cleared.
■ 50 MA	Too loose	Don't. By the time it stops you out, most of the move is gone.

The orphaned order — a real way to lose money on a winning trade

If you set a sell-limit for a partial exit and the trade instead stops out on the trailing stop, **that limit order is still live**. It sits on the book, gets filled later, and silently opens a brand-new position in the opposite direction while you have walked away. Before you close the platform, confirm the position is flat *and* that no working orders remain.

Long, short, and closing them

Long: **buy to open, sell to close**. Short: **sell to open, buy to close**. A take-profit or stop order performs the closing side automatically — which is exactly why an unpaired manual order left behind causes the problem above.

When Not to Trade

The session's own framing: anyone can find a reason to enter. Knowing when to sit out is the skill that separates consistent traders from busy ones.

The 50 and 200 are less than 30 points apart

There is no rotation to capture. The setup does not exist yet — wait for it to.

Price is sideways with no structure

Chop takes money from both directions. Wait for momentum outside the range.

Supply and demand zones overlap

Buyers and sellers have collapsed into the same band. Nothing is transacting with conviction.

High-impact data is imminent

Flat before the release. Trade the reaction, not the anticipation.

Price is at unexplored all-time highs

No structure to the left means no reference levels. Let it run and wait for a setup to form.

You are mid-move and chasing

If you are asking whether you can still get in, the entry has passed. Wait for the next one — there is always a next one.

You already hit your daily goal

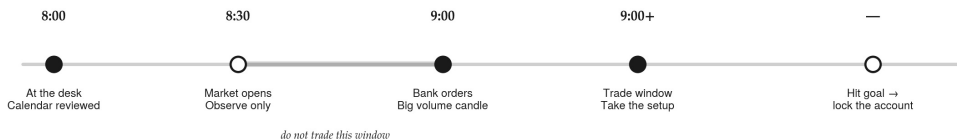
Lock the account. The strongest risk control available is the one that removes the button.

“The best traders know when not to trade. You know when to sit on your hands. You know when to turn off your computer.”

The Daily Routine

Treat it as a job with a start time, a defined window, and an end. The point of a routine is that it removes decisions from the moment you are least equipped to make them.

The daily timeline (all times US Central)



You do not need a 5 a.m. start — you need to be prepared before the bell.

NIGHT BEFORE

- ☐ Review tomorrow's economic calendar
- ☐ Note the times of any high-impact prints
- ☐ Check the finviz map for rotation
- ☐ Re-centre the balance grid if needed
- ☐ Sleep — this one is on the list for a reason

PRE-MARKET

- ☐ Up, showered, dressed, at the desk by 8:00
- ☐ Charts loaded, template applied
- ☐ Measure current 50 / 200 separation
- ☐ Mark unfilled gaps and cost-basis levels
- ☐ Decide today's max risk and stop size

The 9:00 window

Institutional order flow is described as clustering around 9:00 Central, and it usually prints as a single large-volume candle. Stay flat at 8:59. That candle is often — though not reliably — directional for the session, and it is the reference the rest of the morning trades around.

You don't need to be there all day

Most of these setups resolve in 5–20 minutes. The goal is to take the setup, manage it, and log off — not to sit in front of a screen from open to close. A trader who cannot leave the desk has replaced one job with a worse one.

Practice & Progression

Replay drilling — the core exercise

Use TradingView's **Replay** mode. Start a new session, jump to a random point weeks back, and trade it forward blind. The discipline is in the randomness: **do not cheat** by picking a spot where you can already see what happened. Run this until identifying separation, spotting the cross, and placing the stop are automatic.

WHAT TO DRILL, IN ORDER

1. Measure 50/200 separation on sight — is this a setup or not?
2. Identify the 9/21 shoulder tap before the 9/50 cross arrives.
3. Place the stop from structure without thinking about the dollar figure first.
4. Practise trimming and trailing as separate actions on the same trade.
5. Force yourself to skip non-setups — count the trades you correctly *didn't* take.

On funded-account programmes

Evaluation accounts let you trade size for a small fee, with rules: a profit target, a trailing drawdown limit, a consistency rule capping any single day's share of total profit (commonly 50%), and a minimum number of qualifying days before a payout. Breach the drawdown and the account ends.

Read the arithmetic honestly

Sessions like these quote what a strategy produces when it works — four contracts, thousands of dollars, minutes. The same leverage produces the same numbers in reverse, and most evaluation accounts fail. Size accordingly, treat any single fee as spent the moment you pay it, and judge the method by results you produce yourself in replay and in a demo — not by a demonstration.

Quick Reference Card

The trade, start to finish

Check the heat map for rotation. Wait past 9:00. Measure the 50 MA to 200 MA separation — under 30 points, no trade. With separation present, wait for the 9 EMA to cross the 21 as your warning, then **enter when the 9 crosses the 50 EMA**, ideally right at the 50 MA and confirmed by a high-volume candle. Stop goes just beyond the prior swing, sized so reward is at least twice risk. Trim one contract at the 100 MA and at each balance line. Trail behind the 9 EMA — or the 21 if it is close by — and target just short of the 200 MA, the next balance, or the nearest unfilled gap. Exit when a candle closes through the trail. Confirm the position is flat and no orders are left working.

TAKE THE TRADE WHEN

- ☐ 50/200 separation $\geq$ 30 points
- ☐ 9 EMA crosses the 50 EMA
- ☐ Volume expands on the break
- ☐ Price is at a balance extreme
- ☐ Trend structure agrees

STAND DOWN WHEN

- ☐ Separation under 30 points
- ☐ Sideways / no structure
- ☐ Supply and demand overlap
- ☐ High-impact data imminent
- ☐ Daily goal already reached

TARGET PRIORITY

200 MA

NEXT BALANCE LINE

100 MA (TRIM)

UNFILLED GAP

COST BASIS

“Identify the best entry possible, get in, get out, and log off.”

About this document. This is a synthesis of two recorded bootcamp sessions, reorganised into build order. It reflects the instructor’s stated framework and terminology, including informal claims — fill rates, win percentages, the 30-point figure — which are teaching heuristics rather than measured statistics and have not been independently verified. All charts are illustrative constructions built to demonstrate the concepts described, not reproductions of live sessions. Nothing here is financial advice. Leveraged futures trading can lose money rapidly, including more than a strategy demonstration suggests; test any method in replay and simulation, at size you can afford to lose, before committing capital.